MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume XIII *Issue III* *Summer 2023*



Page 3
Meet our new board members!

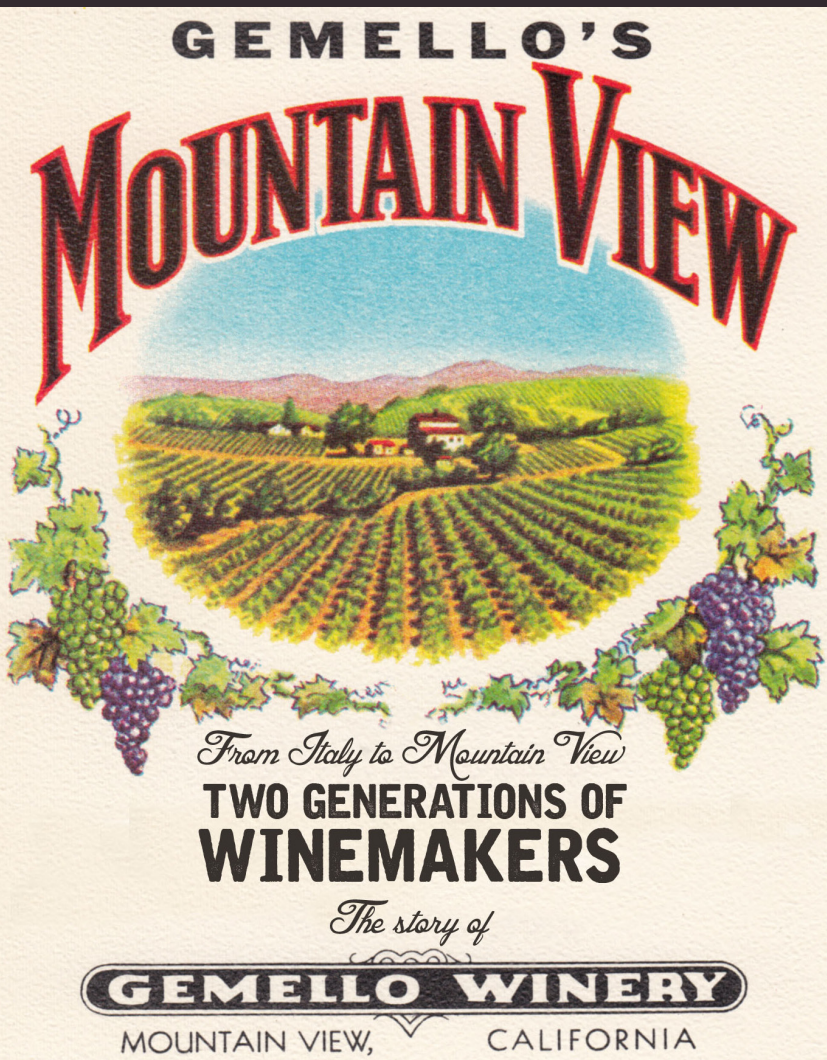


Page 4
Spring event photos & recap



Page 6
Discover the history of MV's Chinese restaurants

SUMMER MEETING + ICE CREAM SOCIAL!



ABOUT THE EVENT

Celebrate summer with us at the historic Adobe Building for our annual Ice Cream Social! We are excited to welcome Kevin Ferguson as our featured guest speaker. Kevin will share 100 years of Mountain View history through the stories of a winemaking family, the Gemellos. For much of the 20th Century the Gemellos operated their family winery on El Camino Real in Mountain View while dealing with the city's growth. Discover their fascinating history while enjoying some delicious ice cream!

OUR GUEST SPEAKER



KEVIN FERGUSON

Kevin Ferguson grew up playing in the orchards of Mountain View and Los Altos, at the home and winery of his maternal grandparents, the Gemellos. He earned a degree in journalism and worked as a reporter in Los Angeles and Las Vegas. After returning home to the Bay Area in the early 2000s, his grandfather, Mario Gemello, shared with him an old cassette tape of his great grandfather telling tales of the old days of Mountain View. It also unlocked a treasure trove of stories of the eldest Gemello's emigration from Italy to the Santa Clara Valley, the struggles during Prohibition and the launch of Gemello Winery in the depths of the Great Depression. These stories are being compiled in a forthcoming book, *Rain on the Monte Bello Ridge, a memoir about health, aging and winemaking*. Early release chapters are already available for those who sign up for his free newsletter at https://gemello.substack.com/.

RESERVE YOUR SPOT TODAY: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

Sunday, August 6, 2023 ● 2:00 to 4:00 p.m. ● The Historic Adobe Building 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View CA

News & Notes

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Newsletter Design & Layout by Nicholas Perry

MVHA Board of Directors
Email: info@mountainviewhistorical.org

President's Message

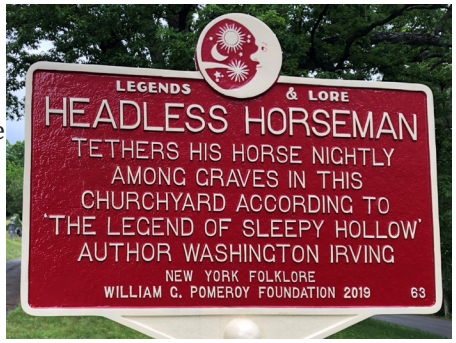


Pamela Baird

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

Looking for History? Visit a cemetery!

On a recent trip to New York for my husband's class reunion at West Point we stayed in Tarrytown. Whenever travel we usually arrive a day early so that we can see the local area.



On this trip we visited the cemetery at nearby Sleepy Hollow- burial site of the author and statesman Washington Irving. It was fun and educational to walk around. There are so many famous and infamous people buried there that a map and guide is published (which only chronicles about 15 people). As we walked around looking for gravesites, we learned about leaders in publishing, business, finance, philanthropy— many of whom we were not aware (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sleepy_Hollow_Cemetery).



In the oldest part of the cemetery there were graves from the 18th century (including three children of Alexander Hamilton) and a monument to Revolutionary soldiers. One gravestone caught my eye with its clever inscription- "The boisterous winds and Neptune's waves have tossed me to and fro. By God's decree you plainly see I am harbored here below."

At the top of the hill mausoleums built by wealthy families were constructed. These structures, although some are small, were carefully detailed and designed. A huge carved panel of a man sitting on an anvil (what is that about?) was a surprise. On the back were the details of the life of Henry Villard, a financier, completer of the Northern Pacific Railroad and early promoter of Civil Service reform. In reading more about him later I was impressed with all that he accomplished during his life (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Henry_Villard).



But obviously cemeteries are places of sadness and grief. Years ago, while visiting Lexington, MA, I walked around town and entered the nearby cemetery. One of gravestones from the late 18th century contained the names of ten children from one family. Buried over the course of twenty years, they had all died before the age of five. How could the parents survive such repeated tragedy? It was a graphic reminder of how lucky we are to live in a world of good nutrition, modern medicine and advanced public infrastructure.

Visiting a cemetery is not ghoulish but a way to learn about history, health, wealth and one's legacy as seen by those who will follow behind us.

—Pamela

MVHA Board Updates

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA Past President

Your MVHA Board of Directors has been hard at work! Read on for some important updates:

Bylaws Update. On May 10 the Board and members in attendance unanimously approved revisions to MVHA Bylaws. The only edit to the proposed revisions (published in our spring newsletter)was to retain the section noting Honored Membership was conferred to Mercedes Castro in recognition of her family's contribution to our community. This section was proposed for deletion but those in attendance on May 10 decided to keep it in the bylaws as part of the historical record. If you would like a mailed or digital copy of the adopted bylaws, please email: info@mountainviewhistorical.org.



Melissa Rusch



Carol Donahue

New Faces on Board! Please join us in welcoming two new faces to our MVHA Board: Melissa Rusch and Carol Donahue. Melissa was appointed Treasurer, replacing Emily Ramos who stepped down to focus on her role on the City Council. Carol Donahue joins our Board as a Director-at-Large focusing on community outreach. Both Melissa and Carol are already making great contributions to our board and we are thrilled to have them join our team.

Familiar Faces, New Positions. A few board members have been appointed to new positions. IdaRose Sylvester is now serving as a Director-at-Large, focusing on the organization's long-term strategic planning. Replacing IdaRose and returning to her past role as Membership Director is Lisa Garcia. Check out the Membership Update on Page 9 for a message from Lisa. Gill Lane, formerly at Director-at-Large is now our Historical Data Director; a role where his in-depth knowledge of Mountain View history and familiarity with our archives is sure to come in handy. We thank all our returning board members!

New Director-at-Large Position Open. Now that the dust has settled on our bylaw revisions and board elections/appointments, we are looking to fill a newly created third Director-at-Large position. This role is flexible and a great introductory role for those interested in serving on a non-profit board. If you are interested please reach out! You can share your interest with any of our friendly board members or contact us at: info@mountainviewhistorical.org.

Financial Report

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

Checking Account Balance as of 3/31/2023: $17,501.52
YTD Income: $1,485.86
YTD Expenses: $2,028.39
Key expenditures: Newsletter, "Then & Now" book purchase, Adobe Building Reservation Deposit, website design
Key income: Membership, Donations, book sales, walking tours

Certificates of Deposit: $60,615.22

MVHA Project Updates

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA Past President

The MVHA continues to work on a number of interesting projects, some of which have been shared in previous editions of this newsletter. Read on for some quick updates!

New MVHA Webmaster. As reported in our last newsletter, the MVHA has a new website. And now, we are pleased to welcome Osama Alamidi as our new volunteer webmaster. Osama is a graphic designer by training looking to build his skills and portfolio in web design. He moved to the Bay Area recently and is interested in learning more about our region's history. The MVHA board will work with Osama to keep our new website fresh and up-to-date.

History Center Updates. Mountain View Public Library staff leadership recently met with representatives from the MVHA board to share a variety of exciting updates related to the Mountain View History Center; the shared home of our MVHA archives and the City of Mountain View archives. The library is in the process of hiring a new librarian who will serve as the coordinator of the History Center. In the interim, librarian Tarri Ryan is serving as the interim coordinator and main point-person to the MVHA. The recently approved City budget for fiscal year 2023-24 included funds to make some small but much-needed upgrades to the History Center's carpeting, seating, and other improvements. Library leadership invited the MVHA to help curate a new gallery wall and relocated display cases along the walls just outside the History Center; with a goal of making some of its collection more visible when the Center itself is closed. An intern is also working to inventory the collection. More extensive plans for upgrades are planned once the new librarian has been hired and on boarded. The MVHA and Library Leadership are planning to begin meeting quarterly to strengthen or long-standing partnership at the History Center, so stay tuned for more updates!

Social Media Updates. MVHA member Jerry Steach is volunteering his professional communications skills to help us increase the amount of fun and interesting historic content we share on various social media platforms like Facebook, Twitter, and LinkedIn. We are investigating setting up an Instagram account as well. If you use social media, we encourage you to connect with us for some great historic content!

Chinatown Interpretive Placard. City staff shared a mock-up of the sign in spring with members of the Race, Equity, and Inclusion Council Subcommittee and is also engaging groups like the Chinese Civil Leadership Academy for feedback on the content. Once this round of important vetting is complete, the City will provide an update on next steps.

MV Eagles Monument. At the time of publication there were no major updates on MVHS Eagles Monument at Eagle Park, but plans continue to progress. Specific questions can be directed to Alberto Olmos at: bombero1@ymail.com.

Spring Event Recap



The History of MEXICAN AMERICAN CIVIL RIGHTS IN THE SANTA CLARA VALLEY, 1920-1960



Above: Dr. Margo McBane, Ph.D. introduces the Before Silicon Valley Project: Mexican Cannery and Agricultural Workers of Santa Clara County, 1920-1960.



Left: San Jose State University Professor Gregorio Mora-Torres speaks about the history of Mexican American Civil Rights in Santa Clara Valley.

For our spring event on May 7 the MVHA partnered with the *Before Silicon Valley* project, a San Jose State University Library initiative focused on chronicling the history of Mexican American cannery and agricultural workers in Santa Clara Valley from the 1920s through 1960s.

To start the event, the MVHA's own Nicholas Perry shared a photo slideshow on the rich and bittersweet history of Mountain View's early 20th century Mexican American neighborhoods: the Washington-Jackson Neighborhood and Castro City.

Then, Dr. Margo McBane introduced the Before Silicon Valley Project and shared a mini-documentary: "The San Jose Chapter of the CSO, 1950s." After Dr. McBane and her team's remarks, Dr. Gregorio Mora-Torres took the mic for the event's featured presentation on Mexican Civil Rights in Santa Clara County in the 1950s, including discussing the story of labor organizer, activist, and writer Ernesto Galarza.



Left: Guests enjoyed fresh Mexican pan dulce (sweet bread) and Mexican sodas graciously provided by the Before Silicon Valley project.

A special moment at the event was when Elena Robles was honored for her special contributions to Mountain View and local Mexican American history. In the 1970s, Elena conducted oral history interviews of Mountain View's Mexican American families. Her interviews were published as part of the oral history book series *Bittersweet: Memories of Old Mountain View* and, most recently, used by the researchers of the Before Silicon Valley project. These important historical records have become priceless windows to the past, especially for the descendants of the individuals interviewed.

The event organizers were very pleased to see a full house of attendees at the Adobe Building with a great mix of new and familiar faces. We hope to see many of you again at our event on August 6! For those who missed it, many of the materials presented will be available on the work-in-progress Before Silicon Valley project website at https://library.sjsu.edu/b4sv (expected completion date is September 30).



Above: Descendants of Simon and Emma Sias, including MVHA board members Nick Perry (right) and Lisa Garcia (center), smile for photo with with a special guest at the event, Elena Robles (third from right). In the 1970s, Elena conducted oral history interviews of Mountain View's Mexican American families, including the Sias family.

Finding Your Family History

By Robert Cox
MVHA Vice President

Birth, marriage, and death records often provide some of the best primary information about our ancestors. In the USA, these documents are associated with the state where the event occurred.

Most states did not start recording births and deaths in a consistent way until around 1900. Marriage records appeared earlier, because of the legal and financial obligations associated with marriage. Early marriage records include the name of the prospective husband and wife and often the name of the bondsman and bond price. The bondsman was usually the father or brother of the prospective bride. If the groom did not or could not marry the bride, the groom forfeited the bond price. Marriage records from later times can also include the names of the parents of the bride and groom, their places of residence, and sometimes ages, birth places, and number of times each was married.

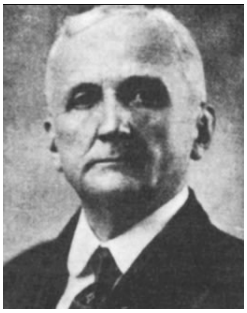
Death records are important because they include information about people who died after 1900 but were often born many years before then. The key information in the death record is provided by an informant, and that information is only good as the informant's knowledge of the deceased. For example, sometimes the deceased's birthplace is more accurately recorded in a contemporary census record. Contemporary information, like the place, time, and cause of death, is generally accurate. Death records often include parents of the deceased and occasionally their birthplaces. If you are looking for an ancestor's parent's name, but they do not appear on his or her death certificate, check the death certificates for his or her siblings. They may have had a more knowledgeable informant. Note that some common causes of death had different names in early times. For example, tuberculosis was called "consumption."

Mtn. View Family History Fun Fact!



Pat Showalter

Former Mayor and current Vice Mayor Pat Showalter is a tenth generation American on her Showalter line. Her seventh great-grandfather, the Reverend Jacob Matthias Schowalder, was a Swiss Mennonite born in 1696. He and his wife Maria Saunders and their eleven children immigrated to Philadelphia in 1750 in the ship "Brotherhood", by way of Rotterdam and Cowes, England. Jacob purchased a 67-acre tract of land in Whitehall Township, Northampton County, Pennsylvania on which to raise his family. Jacob and Maria were the ancestors of many other notable American Showalters, including American gospel music writer Anthony Johnson Showalter, composer of the beloved hymn "Leaning on the Everlasting Arms", New York Mets baseball manager William Nathaniel "Buck" Showalter, and five-time U.S. chess champion Jackson Showalter.



Anthony Johnson Showalter



Jackson Showalter



Buck Showalter

History Happening Now

Mountain View Police Captain Promoted to Police Chief

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

With over 24 years of service in Mountain View, Mike Canfield has been appointed as the new Chief of Police. Kimbra McCarthy, city manager, noted "Mike is deeply rooted in the Mountain View community, having been raised here, graduating from Mountain View High School and serving with the MVPD since January 1999." Canfield was 22 years old when he joined the force.



Chief Mike Canfield

As the twelfth police chief in the city's history, Canfield stated "I am honored to serve as the next police chief of Mountain View. I am deeply aware of how special Mountain View is and the vital role our police department plays in protecting and serving our community."

Canfield rose through the ranks with operational, supervisory and command experience in patrol, investigations and support services. He was promoted to Police Lieutenant in March 2014, and then to Police Captain in December 2020.

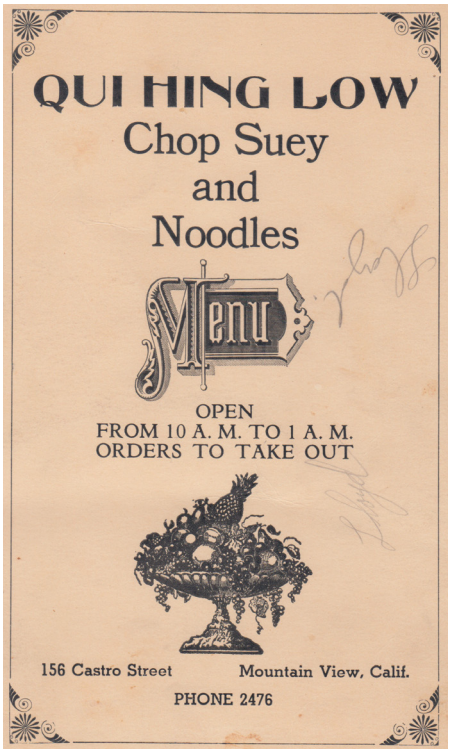


Special Feature:
Chinese Restaurants in Downtown Mtn. View

Two that we trace, created by one extended family, are among Mountain View's most influential and venerated restaurants of any kind.

By Li Zhang and Max Hauser
MVHA Members

Mountain View's downtown business district, which formed after the railroad arrived in 1864, has housed many popular Chinese restaurants. Just in recent decades, such now-vanished establishments as Café Yulong, Chef Liu, Chef Wang, Food Street, Full House, Golden Wok, Han Gen, Hunan Chili, Hunan Gourmet, New China Delight, Plum Garden, Shanghai House, South China, Szechuan Garden, Tien Fu, and Twinkling Spring attracted loyal customers. This article examines two of the most fondly remembered restaurants, of any genre, in Mountain View's history—Qui Hing Low and Andy's—and the immigrant family behind them.



An early Qui Hing Low menu cover.





On top: 100 block of Castro Street in the 1970s.

Above: Circa 1950s photo of Qui Hing Low Cafe's original location at 156 Castro Street with its "Chop Suey" neon sign.

Left: September 1949 advertisement. (Mountain View's telephone exchange, Yorkshire 7, meant early local numbers had "YO 7" prefixes, later 967).

Immigrant Entrepreneurs

Chinese-immigrant-owned businesses had long been a part of downtown Mountain View. Yuen Lung opened a retail store in 1879 at a corner of Villa and View Streets. Other Asian-immigrant-run businesses concentrated nearby. (When Lung died in 1932 a San José newspaper article memorialized him as a "noted citizen.") [Source Note 1]

Not all Chinese immigrants were cordially received. After the transcontinental railroad was completed, leaving Chinese laborers unemployed, Congress passed the Chinese Exclusion Act in 1882, barring immigrant Chinese labor. (Congress repealed it in 1943.)

A study of a NY Public Library menu collection, *150 Years of Chinese Cuisine in America* (https://bit.ly/3qWMinF), concluded that Chinese restaurants in America began with serving poor miners in "chow chow houses" and evolved to the mainstream of US dining, initially by introducing westernized dishes such as chop suey, fried rice, and chow mein as food "exotic" to Americans.

A Visit From San Francisco

In the middle 1930s, Mountain View was a happening place. The new naval air station, Moffett Field, was becoming important. Moffett Field had begun as a joint initiative of Mountain View and Sunnyvale, with the hope of bringing federal jobs to the region during the hard economic times of the early 1930s. By 1935, after a facility swap with the Navy, the Army Air Corps (predecessor of the Air Force) became the main tenant, adding Moffett to its flight training facilities. The airfield brought new customers to Mountain View's nearby Castro Street business district.

Taking the train one morning in 1935 from San Francisco to investigate a restaurant property for rent on Castro, On and Rose Liu, both of whom had prior experience in the restaurant business, faced disappointment initially. The property was already rented.

Before returning to San Francisco, On and Rose stopped at a local ice-cream parlor. The proprietor, Curley Thrower, told the Lius of another suitable property available at 156 Castro, next to his own shop. Curley's tip led eventually to Qui Hing Low (QHL) opening there in January 1936, a successful restaurant for nearly 50 years. It also would lead indirectly to another very popular restaurant: Andy's.

Continued on next page

Margie Opaterny and her sister Judy Gee are nieces of the Lius. Their father Goon You Siu and On Liu were among 13 siblings, some of whom emigrated from China to California. Margie's father immigrated to the US in 1924, marrying Margie's mother in China in 1948, both settling in California by 1949.

Margie was born in Los Angeles, living there until On and Rose, in the 1950s, invited her parents to move to Mountain View and join in the restaurant business. Her parents worked at the restaurant until their retirement. Margie and her sister Judy also worked there from the early 1960s, unloading the dishwasher, bussing dishes, and eventually waiting on tables. Their uncle On made fresh noodles and "gigantic egg rolls," served in four pieces. By then, On and Rose lived on Bush St. near downtown Mountain View and owned rental property around the neighborhood. Some of the property housed restaurant employees.



Grand opening of Andy's Chinese Restaurant, 174 Castro, September 1963.

Andy's Opens

Margie's cousin Muriel (On's niece) and her husband Andrew Chan also came to Mountain View and participated in Qui Hing Low. Andrew worked as a waiter, Muriel in the kitchen. Together in 1963, they opened Andy's Chinese Restaurant nearby at 174 Castro, Andy working the front and Muriel as chef. Menu offerings resembled QHL's. The Andy's photo here shows the formal "Grand Opening" ceremony on September 14.

Andy's (known also as "Andy's Chinese") would become "the other" classic Chinese restaurant in downtown Mountain View. In a 1984 online Sunset magazine article, "Asian foods in downtown Mountain View - nearly two dozen places to eat and shop," (https://bit.ly/3CPtXMf) both Qui Hing Low and Andy's appear. (Note the arrival of telephone area codes; in 1984, Mountain View still shared the 415 code with San Francisco.)

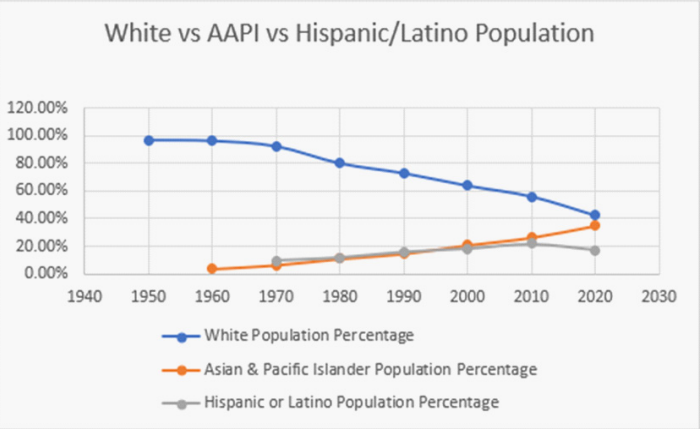
From the 1984 *Sunset* article:

All telephone numbers are area code 415. The most popular places are packed at lunchtime on weekdays and on weekend nights. All the restaurants have take-out service.

Qui Hing Low, 134 Castro; 967-2476.

Andy's Chinese Restaurant, 174 Castro; 968-9494. Under new management, Andy's now offers a dozen kinds of dim sum daily ($1 to $1.35 per plate).

Shifting Demographics



As recently as the 1950s, what would later be named Silicon Valley was still mostly agricultural, with some housing, offices, and manufacturing plants, but many fruit orchards and related businesses—legacies of the pit-fruit industry launched in 1856 [Source Note 2].

Census data recorded a rapidly increasing Mountain View population from 1950 (6,563) to 1980 (67,460), reaching 82,376 in 2020 [source note 3]. The ethnic-Asian component also increased steadily in that period (as shown in the graph of the three largest census ethnic classifications). This suggests that QHL's earlier years served a dining public with far fewer China-connected members. Its advertising shows a correspondingly more Americanized menu, typical of contemporary Chinese restaurants. In its later days, QHL would have faced growing competition from newer, more-authentic Chinese restaurants.



Qui Hing Low's 1968 opening at its "new" second address, 134 Castro. On and Rose Liu are near the center. Margie (then in high school) is the woman farthest on the right, sporting a large flower. "Ray" of the sign was On Liu's nephew, chef at that time.

Later Years

Qui Hing Low was successful enough that the Lius bought a vacant lot at 134 Castro, building a restaurant to their specifications. QHL's second location opened there in 1968, with its own formal ceremony.

Continued on next page

From 1968 to 1976, QHL operated both locations, 156 and 134 Castro [Source Note 4]. The family dubbed them the "old" and "new" restaurants. The 156 Castro site was then closed. In the 1980s when their children expressed no interest in taking over the business, On and Rose sold the 134 Castro property, closing QHL at the same time, March 1984.

On Liu died four months later; Rose lived until 2015. Two of their adult children, David Liu and Sally Lau (both born in Mountain View), live today in adjacent towns.

Margie still lives a few blocks from both QHL sites. Her parents bought the house to be near their employment at the restaurant.

Andy's Chinese Restaurant lasted through the 1980s [source note 5], when the Chans opted to retire. The 1986 newspaper advertisement pictured to the right includes it. This advertisement by the downtown area's business group (CBA) is notable for some details. The hopeful subtitle "Paris on the Peninsula" predates Castro Street's 1990 reshaping to two traffic lanes plus outdoor seating. The then-current restaurant-industry buzzword "Continental Cuisine" is stretched considerably to embrace Mexican, Mongolian, Japanese, Indonesian, even American Soul Food, plus three nominally European-cuisine restaurants. "Chinese" is a large category of listed restaurants (only Kirin, opened 1979, remains today).


DOWNTOWN MTN. VIEW

Paris On The Peninsula

RESTAURANTS BY CUISINE

San Antonio Rd. · Bryant Ave. · Castro St. · Hope St. · El Camino Real · Highway 85 · Evelyn St. · Hwy. 101

During Super Bowl Week, head to Mtn. View for the largest selection of restaurants in the area.

Keep this informative handy dining guide

AMERICAN
Calvin's
Kim's
Mervyn's Lounge
Wienerschnitzel

CHINESE
Mandarin
Chef Wang's
Cho's Mandarin
Ings
House of China
House of Yee
Hui Kiang
Yum Garden

Cantonese
Andy's
Cho's Dim Sum
Kirin's
Lotus Garden
Mui Kiang
Pearl River
Plum Garden
Yu Fung

CHINESE
Northern China
Andy's
Szechwan
House of China
Dynasty

CONTINENTAL
Central Station
French
Central Station
Chez T J

Japanese
Kyo
Tokyo House
Sumi's
Yakko

Indonesian
Bangkok Spoon
Italian
Florentine

Korean
Chef Wang's

CONTINENTAL
Mexican
La Poblanita
The Burrito Factory
Mongolian
Colonel Lee's
Natural Foods
Blue Sky
Pizza (Sit Down) or Take Out
Florentine
Stuft Pizza Bar & Grill
Pizza (Take Out Only)
DJ's

Domino's
Sandwich Shops
Castro Deli
King Croissant
State Deli
T N Spice
Wienerschnitzel
Southern
Quincy's Soul Food
Vietnamese
Bangkok Spoon
Mekong

FOOD & BEVERAGE ADDRESS & PHONE DIRECTORY
ALL PHONES 415 AREA CODE

Andy's Chinese Restaurant	968-9494	174 Castro	King Croissant	960-1066	292 Castro
Bangkok Spoon	968-2038	702 Villa	Kirin's Chinese Rest.	965-1059	485 Castro
Blue Sky Vegetarian	961-2082	336 Bryant	Kyo Restaurant	969-2241	869 W. Dana
Eng's	961-6133	368 Castro	La Poblanita	967-1993	209 Castro
Calvin's Philadelphia Eatery	964-8470	234 Castro	Lotus Gardens	961-3500	210 Hope
Central Station Rest.	961-2433	126 Castro	Mekong Vietnamese Rest.	968-2604	288 Castro
Chef Wang's	969-4574	212 Castro	Mervyn's Fine Foods and Cocktail Lounge	961-1333	236 Castro
Chez T J	964-7466	938 Villa	Mui Kieng	969-8232	895 Villa
Cho's Mandarin Dim Sum	965-1157	273 Castro	Pearl River Seafood	967-1689	246 Castro
Col. Lee's Mongolian BBQ	968-0381	304 Castro	Plum Garden	967-2476	134 Castro
D J's Pizza To Go	969-7050	867 W. Evelyn	Quincy's South Soul Food	965-4161	303 Bryant
Domino's Pizza To Go	964-4001	475 Castro	State Delicatessan	967-9525	194 Castro
Florentine Restaurant	961-6543	118 Castro	Stuft Pizza Bar & Grill	961-1491	191 Castro
House of China	961-7347	102 Castro	Sumi's Restaurant	961-1982	35 W. Dana
House of Yee	961-9694	160 Castro	Szechwan Gardens	969-5614	124 Castro
The Burrito Factory	967-7827	841 Villa	Yakko's Restaurant	960-0626	975 W. Dana
Dynasty	961-6638	360 Castro	Yu Fung Restaurant	969-9494	152 Castro
Castro Deli	968-2232	341-D Castro	Wienerschnitzel	940-9543	383 Castro
Kim's Cafe	965-1464	866 Dana			

(BEVERAGE) BARS

108 Club, 108 Castro · Mervyn's Cocktail Lounge (also a restaurant), 236 Castro · R Club, 155 Castro · Town Club, 180 Castro

The Mountain View Central Business Association

P.O. Box 1163 • MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042


Qui Hing Low's

Specials

(a la carte only)

1. Shrimps cooked with Scrambled Eggs	$3.20
2. Crab Meat cooked with Scrambled Eggs	3.50
3. Sweet & Sour Chicken Wings (Cutlet)	3.20
4. Stripped Beef with Fried Noodles	4.25
5. Beef cooked with French Mushrooms	4.25
6. Pressed Duck (with Sweet & Sour Sauce)	4.50
7. Paper Wrapped Chicken (10)	4.50
8. Beef Steak Cubes	4.75
9. Cashew Nuts cooked with Chicken	4.25
10. Curry cooked with Beef	3.40
11. Sweet & Sour Sauce Shrimp	4.10
12. Butterfly Shrimps (10)	5.50
13. Special Plum Sauce Chicken	3.75
14. Qui Hing Low's Special Chow Mein	2.95
15. Black Mushrooms cooked with Abalone	5.50
16. Pineapple Chicken	4.25
17. Chinese Chicken Salad — crisp	4.65
18. Mixed Vegetables (Meatless)	2.40
19. Sub Gum Won Ton	3.75



Top: 1986 Downtown Mountian View advertisement. Bottom Left: 1970s QHL specials menu. Bottom Right: Margie Opaterny and Li Zhang in 2023. (Photo: Max Hauser.)

In 2018, on the Lost Mountain View Facebook page, Mountain View resident Alan Okuno featured a 1970s QHL Specials menu pictured to the left. It triggered fond memories from locals to whom QHL was a weekly family treat or favorite take out place. Comments cited favorite dishes, some of them Chinese with American twists (this article's coauthor Li Zhang, who grew up in Beijing, recalls no such dishes there as "Peking Beef" or a pork and fish-patty specialty "with a sardine strip").

Looking back at difficulties Chinese immigrants faced in the first half of the 20th century, the saving graces were their hard-working culture and determination to provide a better life for the next generation. These values are well demonstrated in these restaurants' history. Chinese restaurateurs were also adaptable, tailoring their offerings to local taste and ingredients. Thus did Chinese restaurants flourish nationwide, establishing one of the most popular cuisines in the US today. Within Chinese culture, food indeed has historically played a special role. An informal greeting in China is "Have you eaten yet?"

Acknowledgments:

Several people gave generously of their time and memories during our research. We're especially grateful to Margie Opaterny, Judy Gee, David Liu, and to Mark Jack of the Mountain View History Center at the Mountain View Public Library. Unless otherwise noted, all images are from the History Center.

Legacy

That *two* Qui Hing Low locations and Andy's all thrived on one Castro St. block for several years reflects these restaurants' remarkable popularity. The Lius' son David recalls "lines stretching down the street" at times, and customers of all ethnicities, including many from local Japanese-American families, among whom he had many childhood friends. The restaurant successes are more remarkable because these restaurants preceded Castro Street's 1990 reconfiguration to a more restaurant- and pedestrian-friendly format.

This article's authors have encountered many echoes of that popularity among residents old enough to recall the three restaurants. Decades after QHL's closure, its dishes, like Ginger Beef, are still fondly remembered and recounted, as in the 2007 *Mercury News* article, "Home Plates: Memories of Chinese restaurant" (https://bit.ly/3puyGzS).

Source Notes

[1] Nicholas Perry, *Mountain View (Then and Now series)*, Arcadia Publishing, 2012, ISBN 0738595764, page 28.

[2] Aubrey Drury, in 1935, traced the then-booming Santa Clara County pit-fruit industry to Louis Pellier's original 1856 experimental prune grove. *California: An Intimate Guide*, chapter 19. New York: Harper and Brothers, 1935.

[3] Census data: City of Mountain View Census Data (http://www.bayareacensus.ca.gov/cities/MountainView.htm) and "2020 census shows Mountain View grew fast, driven by increase in Asian population" (https://bit.ly/3XCLukb).

[4] Dates for QHL locations: *Pacific Telephone directories*, 1976-1982.

[5] Listed in 1989 *Haines Directory*, vacant in 1990 volume.

Membership

By Lisa Garcia
MVHA Membership Chair

Hello everybody! After a four year hiatus I am happy to return as your membership chair/director. Please bear with me as I get myself up to speed again. Thank you to all of you who have renewed for those of you who haven't, it's never too late. If you have any questions and need to contact me, please send an email to membership@mountaiviewhistorical.org or leave me a message at (323) 705-5650 and I will return your call. I'm excited to be back!

Welcome to our new members: Melissa & Paul Rusch, Ron Nakao, John Kostka, Elizabeth Thompson, and Sean Horan.



In Memoriam: Eugene Sharp

We are sad to share news of the passing of longtime MVHA member Eugene Sharp. Eugene and his wife Nancy were familiar faces at MVHA events, especially in the 2000s and 2010s. Eugene also served on our board of directors for many years. Nancy wanted to let our members know Eugene passed away on June 10, 2023 and that memorial services are planned in August. For details, please reach out to Eugene's son, Andrew Sharp, via email at acsoutbound13@frontier.com or phone at (206) 355-7302. Our condolences to Nancy and to Eugene's family and friends.



Harvest History Festival

MVHA Member Marina Marinovich is helping organize the fifth anual Mountain View Harvest History Festival on September 16 at Heritage Park and shared this flyer above. Hope to see you there!

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. You can also join and renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Membership is tax deductible to the extent permitted by law. The MVHA is a tax-exempt organization under Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), Tax ID 94-6115407.
Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Household Annual Membership *$30/year*
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Thank you!

SUMMER 2023

August 2 & September 13
Wednesday, 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.

MVHA Board Meetings
Virtual Zoom Meeting
All interested members welcome to attend!
Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org for login.

August 6
Sunday, 2:00 p.m. to 4:00 p.m.

Summer Event + Ice Cream Social
The Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View
More information on page 1

July 23 & September 24
Sunday, 2:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.

Downtown Walking Tours
Centennial Plaza, 600 W. Evelyn Ave, Mtn. View
Details at: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

Save the Dates!

September 16
Saturday, 9:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m.

Mtn. View Harvest History Festival
Heritage Park, 771 N. Rengstorff Avenue
More information on page 9.

November 12
Sunday, Time TBD

Fall Event + Meeting
The Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View
Details in our next newsletter!

Looking Back: Images from the Archive



Gemello Winery sign on El Camino Real in 1955
(Source: Katherine Gemello)



Gemello Village sign at same location in 2011
(Source: Nick Perry, photo by Kim Chan)

In anticipation of our August 6 event on the history of local wine-making family the Gemellos, here's a then and now photo comparison of signage sporting the family name. The 1955 photo shows the sign for the Gemello Winery with a still semi-rural El Camino Real in the distance. The 2011 photo shows signage for the Gemello Village a mixed-use development with retail on the ground floor and housing above at 2043 W El Camino Real that was built on land once occupied by the winery. The nearby Gemello Park and surrounding Gemello Neighborhood also bear the family name. We hope you'll join us on August 6 to learn more about the Gemellos and their contributions to local history! See Page 1 for more information.

EST. 1954
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